

Week 11: Decolonizing Adult Learning & AI Integration

1. Colonial Individualism

Knowles universalized Western values (self-direction, independence) as natural human characteristics, erasing cultural specificity and serving neoliberal capitalism's need for atomized workers.

2. False Child/Adult Dichotomy

The distinction between pedagogy and andragogy is one of degree, not kind. Children possess innate self-direction and curiosity that reproductive pedagogies systematically destroy.

3. Workforce Training vs. Liberation

Adult education often reduces to workforce development (Agile). Frameworks serve different masters: AI taxonomy supports learner agency, while Agile optimizes productivity metrics.

4. Strategic Tool Evaluation

Question frameworks by asking: Whose interests do they serve? What possibilities do they foreclose? Can tools be appropriated for liberatory purposes, or do they encode domination?

"This presupposed that all humans and cultures valued ideals such as individualism, self-realisation, independence, and self-direction."

— **Loeng (2018), critiquing Knowles's andragogy**



Fig. 3 The integrated taxonomy of learning with generative AI including subcategories, AI role descriptions, and agentic leveling.